

Econ 10010/20010: Principles of Microeconomics
Summer 2026
University of Notre Dame

Course Details

Instructor: Xinyi Li

Email: xli35@nd.edu

Office: Jenkins and Nanovic Hall (JNH) 3018

Class Meeting Times: Monday/Tuesday/Wednesday/Thursday from 1:00 pm - 3:15 pm

Class Location: Jenkins and Nanovic Hall B071

Class Site: canvas.nd.edu

Office Hours and Locations:

Tuesday 9-11 a.m. (Jenkins and Nanovic Hall 3005)

Thursday 9-11 a.m. (Jenkins and Nanovic Hall 3005)

Friday 12:30-2:30 p.m. (Jenkins and Nanovic Hall 3005)

Or by appointment (Jenkins and Nanovic Hall 3018)

Course Overview

Every day, people face tradeoffs about how to spend their time, money, and effort. Firms face similar decisions about what to produce, how much to produce, and how to compete in the marketplace. This undergraduate course serves as an introduction to microeconomics, the study of how individuals, businesses, and societies make choices when resources are scarce—in other words, “who gets what, how, and why.”

Throughout the course, we will explore questions such as: What is a market? How are prices determined? What makes markets work—and sometimes fail? How do consumers and firms make decisions? We will learn how economists approach these questions using simple but powerful analytical tools. By developing economic intuition and working with simple models, we will see how economics can shed light on complicated real-world problems.

By the end of the course, you will have a basic foundation in “how to think like an economist” when analyzing everyday decisions and policy questions.

Required Course Material

1. A phone/tablet with access to Poll Everywhere software
2. Textbook: *Microeconomics* by Hubbard and O'Brien, any edition

Note: This textbook is an additional resource for reviewing the concepts covered in class. You will **NOT** be responsible for the material in the textbook that is not covered in class.

Tentative Course Outline (Subject to Change)

Date	#	Topic	Assignment Due
Wednesday 6/17	1	Intro, Opportunity Cost, Trade	
Thursday 6/18	2	Markets, Supply, and Demand	
Monday 6/22	3	Markets, Supply, and Demand	Problem Set #1
Tuesday 6/23	4	Equilibrium Analysis	Quiz #1
Wednesday 6/24	5	Elasticity	
Thursday 6/25	6	Elasticity, Price Controls	Location: 232 Debartolo Hall
Monday 6/29	7	Taxation and Subsidies	Problem Set #2
Tuesday 6/30	8	Externalities	Quiz #2
Wednesday 7/1	9	Public Goods, Coase Theorem	
Thursday 7/2	10	Producer Theory	
Monday 7/6	11	Producer Theory	Problem Set #3
Tuesday 7/7	12	Firms in Competitive Markets	Quiz #3
Wednesday 7/8	13	Monopoly and Market Power	
Thursday 7/9	14	Monopolistic Competition	Problem Set #4
Monday 7/13	15	Oligopoly, Game Theory	Quiz #4
Tuesday 7/14	16	Catch Up/Review Session	Problem Set #5
Wednesday 7/15	17	Student Presentations/Review Session	
Thursday 7/16	18	Final Exam	

Requirements and Grading Rubric

- A. Attendance and Participation (15%)** Attendance is required. The only exceptions are absences which are excused due to official University-sanctioned activities, illness, or unforeseen emergencies. In general, you should communicate with me prior to any excused absence, and follow up by providing documentation to verify the reason for the absence. I will work with you, either by providing a recording of the lecture and/or through a personal appointment, to ensure that you are caught up on any material missed due to an excused absence.

Everyone is expected to participate in class. A large portion of lecture time will be devoted to discussion and in-class exercises, so the more that you engage with the material during class, the more that you (and your classmates) will get out of this course.

Along with asking and answering questions during lectures, we will use Poll Everywhere to facilitate engagement. During lecture, I will often present multiple-choice questions and you will use Poll Everywhere to respond. Prior to our first class, you will receive information on how to activate your Poll Everywhere account and set up the Poll Everywhere app for your phone or tablet.

Your Attendance and Participation grade will be based on the percentage of Poll Everywhere questions that you *answer* – not the percentage that you answer correctly. To allow for technical problems and other issues, there will be a curve on your Poll Everywhere score (not to exceed a total score of 100%).

- B. Problem Sets (20%)** There will be 5 problem sets assigned throughout the course. You are encouraged to work in groups on the problem sets, but you must turn in your own solutions. The problem sets are designed to help you grasp and apply the concepts discussed in class. Late problem set submissions will receive at most half credit.
- C. Presentations (10%)** Each student will be required to participate in one 2-person presentation at the end of the semester. Each pair of students will choose an article and then present the article. Each presentation should be about ten minutes, and students may not be able to cover all the material in the article. At a minimum, each presentation should address the following (1) What are the main economic concepts discussed in the article? (2) How can these concepts be explained using the economic tools and principles we have learned in class? Beyond these requirements, you are free to decide which aspects of the article to emphasize, what material to omit, and what additional insights, applications, or extensions you would like to share with the class. Creativity and thoughtful connections to course material are encouraged.
- D. Quizzes (25%)** Every week there will be a quiz. All quizzes will take place in the last 30-45 minutes of class time. For each quiz you may use a simple four-function calculator and a single 3 x 5-inch notecard (“cheat sheet”) containing your own handwritten notes (can use one side only). There are four quizzes in total, but I will drop your lowest score when calculating your grade. There are no makeup quizzes for unexcused absences. If you miss a quiz due to an unexcused absence, that miss will be counted as your lowest score and will be dropped. You will receive a zero for each additional quiz you miss due to an unexcused absence.
- E. Final Exam (30%)** The final exam will take place on the last day of class (July 16, 2026) at our usual meeting time and in our usual classroom. Per ND rules, you must have a valid excuse from the Dean to take the final exam at a time other than the scheduled time. Other university exam policies can be found online (<https://al.nd.edu/advising/academic-policies/final-exams/>). If you miss the final exam and do not have an excuse from the Dean, you will receive a score of 0% on your final. For the final, you may use a single 8.5 x 11-inch sheet of paper (“cheat sheet”) containing your own handwritten notes (can use one side only).

Letter grades will be assigned as follows:

A	93-100
A-	90-92.99
B+	87-89.99
B	83-86.99
B-	80-82.99
C+	77-79.99
C	73-76.99
C-	70-72.99
D	60-69.99
F	0-59.99

I will be using the gradebook on the course website through Canvas. This will allow you to keep close track of your performance in the course.

Email Communications

I will communicate class announcements through announcements on Canvas. You can set up notifications from Canvas to be sent to you via email. For all email communications, please use your @nd.edu address. I will do my best to respond to your emails within 24 hours.

Phone/Laptop Policy

This course is designed so that you do not need a laptop during lecture. Research shows that in-class laptop use has a negative impact on learning outcomes and overall course performance (<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0272775716303454>). Therefore, laptops are not permitted during class. Additionally, phone/tablet use is not permitted in class, except as a means to access “Poll Everywhere”. If you are observed using a phone or laptop during class, your participation score will be reduced.

If you think that taking notes on a tablet would be especially beneficial for you, please talk to me during the first week of class and we can discuss an exception.

Academic Honesty

You are expected not to engage in academic dishonesty. One of the goals of this course is to prepare you to do well in advanced economics courses and build the basic foundations for research projects and future careers, so it is essential that you develop a solid understanding of the material. To that end, while collaboration on problem sets is encouraged in this course, copying is not. Students are expected to understand and abide by the University’s honor code.

Support for Mental Health:

The University Counseling Center (UCC) provides cost-free and confidential mental health services to help you manage personal challenges that threaten your emotional or academic well-being. Remember, getting help is a smart and courageous thing to do. For more resources, please see ucc.nd.edu. During our course period, you can also speak with me at any time if you would like to.

Disability Services:

It is the policy and practice of the University of Notre Dame to provide reasonable accommodations for students with properly documented disabilities. Students who have questions about the Office of Disability Services or who have, or think they may have, a disability are invited to contact the Office of Disability Services for a confidential discussion in the Sara Bea Center for Students with Disabilities or by phone at (574) 631-7833. Because the University’s Academic Accommodations Processes generally require students to request accommodations well in advance of the dates when they are needed, students who believe they may need an accommodation for this course are encouraged to contact the Office of Disability Services at their earliest opportunity. Additional information about Disability Services and the process for requesting accommodations may be found at supportandcare.nd.edu.

Use of AI:

For the purposes of this class, you may not use ChatGPT or other AI software.

Inclusive Classroom:

The University of Notre Dame is committed to social justice. I share that commitment and strive to maintain a positive learning environment based on open communication, mutual respect, and non-discrimination. In this class, we will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, age, economic class, disability, veteran status, religion, sexual orientation, gender identity, color, or national origin. Any suggestions as to how to further such a positive and open environment will be appreciated and given serious consideration.

Title IX:

Lauren's Promise: I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening or harassing you.

Lauren McCluskey, a 21-year-old student at the University of Utah and the daughter of economist Jill McCluskey was murdered on Oct. 22, 2018 by a man she briefly dated. I am committed to doing what I can to make sure this does not happen again.

If you are in immediate danger, call 911. If you are experiencing sexual assault, domestic violence, stalking, or harassment you can report it to me. You should be aware that I am a mandatory reporter, which means that I am required to report these instances to the university's Title IX Coordinator or Deputy Title IX Coordinator to investigate. You can also learn about your options (on-campus and off-campus, confidential and not) at <https://equity.nd.edu/>

The University of Notre Dame provides services for those who have been affected by sexual assault, sexual misconduct, dating or domestic violence, stalking and any conduct that creates a hostile environment. For help and further information including contact information for on and off-campus resources, please consult <https://equity.nd.edu/resources/>.